

Web Dev Course Syllabus

Course Description

This 4-week-long course composed of four 1-hour lessons teaches you how to code a website.

But wait, why would you want to code a website when there exists ways to build a website drag-and-drop, no coding, like by using something like Wix or SquareSpace?

Well first off, if you build a website drag-and-drop, you end up paying around \$16 or \$17 a month for something like Wix or SquareSpace [note: Wix has a free option with ads for \$0]. If you write or have code, deployment to something like Vercel or Netlify costs \$0 a month [and no ads]. In this class, we will be deploying to Vercel and paying \$0. We might also do Wix at the end. We might do Shopify at the end if people want to build a shop drag-and-drop, depending on student interest.

Anyway, in addition, code is not limited the way drag-and-drop website building inside a website like SquareSpace or Wix is. Code can be expanded and built upon to build large and complex websites and web applications that cannot be built by a drag-and-drop tool like SquareSpace or Wix. Note that we do not have time to learn how to build large or complex web applications in a 4-hour course, but this course should establish fundamentals that can be built upon.

Course Textbook

There is one textbook for this course. It is recommended, but if you are okay learning from YouTube tutorials, then you can skip the book in favor of the YouTube tutorials.

The textbook is:

HTML, CSS, & JavaScript All-In-One by Paul McFedries

It can be bought at the following (case-sensitive) shortened Amazon link:

<https://a.co/d/0dJQZjKs>

I know the link is printed on paper in class, so you can't just click it, but it should be possible to open up a web browser like Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome and type the link into the text bar at the top of the web browser to get to that website. If you want,

you can leave out the “https://” in the beginning and just type in “a.co/d/0dJQZjKs” (without quotes around it).

Note that the textbook is composed of 5 “mini-books”. The first lecture of this 4-lecture course corresponds to “Book 2” in that book, “Learning HTML Basics”. The second lecture of this 4-lecture course corresponds to “Book 3” in that textbook, “Learning CSS Basics”. The third lecture of this 4-lecture course corresponds to “Book 4” in that book, “Building Dynamic Pages with JavaScript” (note: we might skip JavaScript if we don’t have time or if there is a lack of interest). Finally, the fourth lecture of this 4-lecture course will be about using AI (ex. ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, etc.) to generate the code for you, and then you can run, read, and edit the code that AI spits out [note: the laptop I (the instructor) was given for this class is very locked down, so we MIGHT not be able to do AI. If that happens, we will use the AI time for Google Sites or Wix instead].

Course YouTube Tutorials

If you prefer to learn from YouTube videos, the first lecture corresponds to this YouTube video on HTML (link shortened to domain nameyoutu.be):

https://youtu.be/HD13eq_Pmp8

The second lecture corresponds to the CSS portion of this YouTube video (note: link is case-sensitive):

<https://youtu.be/HGTJBPNC-Gw>

The third lecture corresponds to this YouTube video about JavaScript:

<https://youtu.be/lkIFF4maKMU>

There is no official book or YouTube video for the fourth lesson, we will mostly be playing around with AI, generating code [and/or using Google Sites or Wix].

Learning Objectives

This is a hands-on course. The objective of this course is to build a website. Please bring your laptop into class if you can. Everyone who completes this course should walk out with a cool free website that belongs to them.

Instructor Communication and Office Hours

Please come into the Office Hours & Tech Clinic, Saturdays 1:30 PM to 2:30 PM. I will answer questions and provide extra help there. If for whatever reason you cannot make it, my email address is:
JohnMichaelReedFAS@GMail.com

As this information is relevant, my name is “John Michael Reed” and the “FAS” in my email address stands for “Faculty of Arts and Sciences” (I wanted to be a university professor at the time I created that email address).

Note: Because it is inconvenient for me to wait for people to show up for office hours, please let me know if you will be attending. If nobody emails me or shows up to office hours within the first 10 minutes, I reserve the right to leave office hours early.

Course Website

The website for this course is at:
<https://website-for-web-class.vercel.app/>

On the course website you will find some pre-recorded lectures in case you have to miss a lecture, as well as copies of the lecture slides in case you need to review. The lectures build on top of each other, so you need to understand the previous lectures in order to understand the future ones.

Finally, at the bottom of the course website is a section to leave (optionally anonymous) feedback on the course. Please leave feedback so I can make the course better for future students.

Homework

If you want homework, please buy and read the textbook or re-watch the course YouTube videos or the course lectures and slides (which again, are on the course website).

Quizzes

I reserve the right to give quizzes to help you test and refresh your memory. Everyone who takes this class gets an “A”, so do not stress about the quizzes.

Please initial below to indicate that you read and understand the syllabus:
